# The Emancipation Proclamation & the Gettysburg Address

*President Abraham Lincoln · January 1, 1863 & November 19, 1863*

*Source: U.S. National Archives, archives.gov/founding-docs and archives.gov/exhibits/featured-documents/emancipation-proclamation.*

The Emancipation Proclamation (Jan. 1, 1863) used Lincoln's war powers to declare enslaved people in Confederate-held territory 'forever free' and to authorize Black enlistment in the Union Army. The Gettysburg Address (Nov. 19, 1863), delivered at the dedication of the battlefield cemetery, reframed the war as a struggle to make the Declaration of Independence's promise of equality real. Read together, the two documents mark Lincoln's redefinition of the war's purpose.

*Connect: The Gettysburg Address invokes 'all men are created equal.' How is Lincoln in 1863 using the Declaration (Class 3) to redefine what the war is about?*

## Key Passages

### Emancipation Proclamation

> I do order and declare that all persons held as slaves within said designated States and parts of States are, and henceforward shall be free; and that the Executive government of the United States, including the military and naval authorities thereof, will recognize and maintain the freedom of said persons.

### Emancipation — Black enlistment

> And I further declare and make known that such persons of suitable condition will be received into the armed service of the United States.

### Gettysburg Address — opening

> Four score and seven years ago our fathers brought forth on this continent a new nation, conceived in liberty, and dedicated to the proposition that all men are created equal.

### Gettysburg Address — closing

> It is rather for us to be here dedicated to the great task remaining before us … that this nation, under God, shall have a new birth of freedom, and that government of the people, by the people, for the people, shall not perish from the earth.

## HIPP Analysis

*Complete each row using evidence from the passages and your background knowledge.*

| HIPP Element | Your Analysis |
|---|---|
| ***Historical Situation***<br>*What was happening when this was written?* | |
| ***Intended Audience***<br>*Who was the source written for?* | |

| HIPP Element | Your Analysis |
|---|---|
| ***Purpose***<br>*What did the author want to accomplish?* | |
| ***Point of View***<br>*Whose perspective? Whose is missing?* | |

## Analysis Prompts

**1.** LEQ Specific Evidence (1 pt): Use TWO specific pieces of evidence from these documents to argue that the war's purpose changed between 1861 and 1863.

**2.** What did the Emancipation Proclamation NOT do — and why is that important?

**3.** How does the Gettysburg Address reframe the founding documents?